



Matthew Hutchinson <matthewthutcheon1@gmail.com>

Virtual Qualifier Round 1 – What to Expect & How to Submit

1 message

AI Grand Prix <contact_aigp@theaigraprix.com>

Thu, Feb 19, 2026 at 3:44 AM

To: "matthewthutcheon1@gmail.com" <matthewthutcheon1@gmail.com>

Hi Matthew Hutchinson,

As promised, here are more details about the 1st Virtual Qualifier (Round 1) - and what you should prepare for.

What Round 1 Looks Like:

The first qualifier will take place inside a virtual environment designed to focus purely on autonomy performance. No visual gimmicks.

You can expect:

- A structured 3D racecourse with a defined number of standardized gates.
- Clear gate sequencing — all gates must be passed in the correct order.
- Realistic drone physics and flight dynamics.
- A time-based scoring system — fastest valid run wins but the main goal is to pass gates.
- The emphasis is on precision, stability, and speed under realistic physical constraints.

Technical Framework & Code Submission:

Round 1 will be executed through a Windows-based downloadable application built on DCL's competition platform. Exact hardware requirements will be communicated in the upcoming newsletters, but a recent mid-tier PC with a dedicated graphics card should generally do. We will make sure that the team with the best coding skills is fastest, not the one with the most hardware budget.

Your task:

Prepare your Python-based autonomy stack, which will be integrated into the simulator and executed in a controlled evaluation environment. In the coming weeks, we will provide more information on interface specifications, input/output definitions, detailed submission instructions, exact opening & deadline dates, etc.

Code Ownership — Important Clarification:

We've received several questions regarding intellectual property. You retain full ownership of your algorithm, source code, and documentation. By submitting your entry, you grant the AI Grand Prix permission to use your code strictly for operating, monitoring, and judging the competition and only for the duration of the competition period. We will use this access to monitor the code to avoid cheating, exploitation and human interference, but there is no transfer of IP to Anduril or any founding partner.

Entry Fee:

We would like to emphasize again that there are no entry fees for teams. However, each participating team is responsible for covering its own expenses related to the AI Grand Prix, including travel, accommodation, and any additional costs incurred.

What's Next:

Next week, we will share preliminary technical interface details and additional specifications and updated FAQs to help you prepare.

Now is the time to test, iterate, and stress-test your autonomy stack.

Good luck and happy coding,

The AI Grand Prix Team

contact_aigp@theaigraprix.com

theaigraprix.com